preparation would take. The RBI also flagged what would happen if preparation was inadequate.'[22]

Reinforcing these points in April 2018,[23] Rajan said, 'I have made it quite clear that we were consulted and we didn't think it was a good idea,' and '…*Demonetization was not a well-planned, well thought-out, useful exercise* and I told the government that, when the idea was first mooted.'

Responding to a comment from the audience that demonetization could have positively impacted growth, Rajan said wryly, '*You would have to find a new economic theory to explain how it helped the economy.*'

It is, therefore, evident from Rajan's feedback that he was consulted on demonetization, but the RBI under his stewardship had indicated to the government in no uncertain terms that it was not advisable. The RBI had also clearly outlined the preparations that would be needed, and the consequences of inadequate preparations.

Whether this was the reason for the orchestrated campaign to remove him will remain a matter of speculation. Given that Deputy Governor Gandhi's statements seem to contradict those of the former Governor, it seems that if the RBI was involved in the planning, Rajan was not aware of this and that the 'formal planning' only commenced after Urjit Patel, his successor, was in position, on 4 September 2016.

If Not the RBI, Who Were the Planners?

To date there has been no official confirmation of the names of the members of the 'small team' constituted by the Prime Minister. There was considerable media speculation as to whether the Finance Minister himself had been consulted or was part of the team.

The Wall Street Journal captured the rumours circulating in Lutyens' Delhi:

> Demonetization has resurrected fears that the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party takes policy advice from quacks. It damaged the credibility of India's central bank... It also